

# Easton Hawk, RHP, UCLA

2026 Stats: 1.93 ERA/42 IP/1.143 WHIP/52 K/19 BB/2.74 K:BB

6-3, 210

## Metrics

FB: 95.3/18 IVB/12.8 HB/-4.61 VAA/6.6 ext/6.2 relH/31.5% zone/44.5 AA/34.7% usage/2330 rpm

SI: 96.3/13.1 IVB/15.7 HB/-6.17 VAA/43.7% zone/39.5 AA/14.1% usage/2330 rpm

CB: 81.1/-6 IVB/-9.6 HB/-9.19 VAA/34.9% zone/43.3 AA/5.9% usage/2360 rpm

SL: 84.8/-0.1 IVB/-5.2 HB/-7.99 VAA/25.2% zone/39.1 AA/36.9% usage/2210 rpm

CH: 88.6/8.7 IVB/15.4 HB/-6.9 VAA/13.6% zone/37.3 AA/6% usage/1780 rpm

SP: 84.8/3.4 IVB/10.4 HB/-7.63 VAA/41.2% zone/34.1 AA/2.3% usage/1340 rpm

## Write-up

Easton Hawk emerged as UCLA's full-time closer for the wire-to-wire No. 1 team in the country and enters 2027 as one of the more intriguing conversion candidates from relief to starting pitching. The 6-foot-3 right-hander is a fluid mover with long levers, premium arm speed, and a deep arsenal highlighted by a mid-to-upper-90s fastball that touched 100 mph and a wipeout slider capable of missing bats against both handednesses. Hawk's development throughout the season was particularly encouraging, as he largely phased out a seldom-used splitter in favor of a changeup that showed legitimate promise and generated a 16% swinging-strike rate. The combination of athleticism, velocity, and a starter-caliber pitch mix gives Hawk a realistic opportunity to transition into a weekend role at UCLA next spring. While the strike throwing remains the primary question, the underlying traits suggest one of the highest ceilings among returning college arms. If the command holds up under a starter's workload, Hawk has the ingredients to establish himself as one of the premier pitching prospects in the 2027 draft class.

The FB is a power offering with above-average ride, plus velocity, and meaningful arm-side movement that creates difficult looks to both handednesses. Hawk is able to elevate for whiffs while also getting enough run to avoid being a purely north-south fastball. The command is still developing, reflected in

the modest zone rate, but he consistently worked to the edges rather than leaking into the heart of the plate. The pitch generated chase above the zone and enough weak contact when located gloveside.

There is some reliever risk in the command profile with a slight tendency to yank it down and gloveside, but the combination of velocity, shape, and extension gives the pitch a chance to play as an above-average major league fastball. 50/55 pitch

The SI serves as an excellent complement to the four-seam, providing a distinct movement profile without sacrificing velocity. Sitting over 96 mph with above-average run and solid depth, the pitch allows Hawk to attack right-handed hitters differently while preventing them from sitting on the riding fastball. He showcased the ability to throw it up and away from lefties off of the high FB giving an interesting look and playing a plus angles game. The sinker is unlikely to ever be a featured weapon, but it is more than enough to protect the four-seam and diversify the attack plan. Upping it's usage and trusting that armside command can up the LT value of this pitch. 45/50 pitch

The SL is the premier pitch in the arsenal and the primary reason Hawk projects comfortably into high-leverage professional innings. Thrown in the mid-80s, it combines late depth with enough gloveside movement to miss bats garnering 53 whiffs overall and 49 against righties. Hawk showed advanced feel for getting the pitch down and gloveside, particularly with two strikes, where it functioned as a true putaway offering. The shape is relatively consistent and the velocity allows it to maintain effectiveness even if hitters identify it early. It already profiles as an impact bat-missing pitch and could become one of the better breaking balls in college baseball if he transitions successfully into a starter's role. 55/60+ pitch

The CB is used sparingly but provides a distinct look from the slider. It features above-average depth and enough sweep to change eye levels and steal strikes early in counts with its 44% CSW on 14% SWSTR. The pitch currently lacks the command and consistency of the slider, and Hawk rarely relied upon it in leverage situations. Still, the shape is intriguing and the separation from the rest of the arsenal gives it value as a fourth offering. More frequent usage could help determine whether it develops into a legitimate weapon or remains a show-me pitch. 40/45 pitch

The CH emerged as the biggest developmental win of Hawk's 2026 season. After largely abandoning the splitter, he leaned into a changeup that showed promising fade, above-average velocity separation, and improving feel for the bottom of the zone. The pitch generated a 16% swinging-strike rate despite limited usage and showed the ability to miss bats against left-handed hitters while also producing soft contact. The command remains inconsistent and the sample is relatively small, but the traits are present for an above-average major league changeup. He was able to get it down and armside to lefties and the pitch moved late with its fade spin. Its continued development will likely determine whether Hawk remains a reliever or successfully transitions into a starting role. 45/55+ pitch

The SPL was largely phased out as the season progressed and appears to have been superseded by the changeup. It flashed occasional depth and low-spin characteristics but lacked the consistency and command necessary to become a reliable part of the arsenal with the pitch hitting the zone rather than diving beneath it. With the changeup showing significantly more promise, the splitter currently projects as a pure back up option rather than a meaningful long-term weapon. 30/35 pitch